

Letter of Reference

Mr. Yashar Mahmood Lashkar, born March 3, 1993, was employed as a research assistant within the Digital Health group of the Corporate Development in International Competition department at the Fraunhofer Center for International Management and Knowledge Economy IMW, Leipzig, from March 16, 2023 to March 15, 2024.

The Fraunhofer-Gesellschaft is Europe's leading organization for applied research. Its research activities are conducted by 76 institutes and research units at locations across Germany. More than 30,000 employees work together to generate the annual research volume of 2.9 billion euros. Of this sum, 2.5 billion euros is generated through contract research. The Fraunhofer-Gesellschaft earns around 70 percent of this revenue through contracts with industry and publicly funded research projects. International collaboration with outstanding research partners and innovative enterprises from around the world facilitate direct access to the most important areas of present-day and future research and business.

The Fraunhofer Center for International Management and Knowledge Economy IMW has over 16 years of experience in application-oriented socio-economic research in Leipzig. Around 220 employees from 24 countries help customers and partners from the fields of business, industry, politics, research and social affairs to benefit from globalization and digital transformation as driving forces for innovation. The institute's international projects, network activities, and analyses are centered around the benefits of socio-economic and applied research for humans, the dynamics of a knowledge-based society and the future of industrial production.

Mr. Lashkar's main duties were as follows:

- Implemented new crawlers to enhance data gathering processes
- Redesigned the layouts of newsletter emails for improved user engagement

- Implemented safeguards using Aeternitas to manage high-volume web requests, ensuring optimal server performance
- Updated multiple web pages on an internal website with fresh and relevant content
- Developed new jobs and database migrations to support ongoing project requirements

Mr. Lashkar also demonstrated in-depth knowledge of areas adjacent to his own specialism, which he used to great effect on a daily basis. His ability to grasp things quickly meant he could instantly form an accurate understanding of even the most tricky situations and always spot what was essential.

He always showed great initiative and fully embraced his tasks and our institute. His exemplary level of enthusiasm was particularly impressive. He was always completely open to new ideas and constantly willing to learn.

He proved to be exceptionally resilient over the long term, even in situations with the heaviest workloads. He worked extremely quickly, with total diligence, extreme care and precision at all times. Of particular note was Mr. Lashkar's total and unconditional reliability and honesty. He always produced outstanding work in both qualitative and quantitative terms.

Mr. Lashkar fulfilled all of his responsibilities to our complete satisfaction.

For his constantly friendly and even-tempered nature, he was held in high esteem by all. He was always helpful, courteous and, if necessary, put personal interests aside. His conduct towards managers and colleagues was, without exception, exemplary and loyal.

We regret that our employment relationship ends on March 15, 2024 due to its fixed term. We would like to thank Mr. Lashkar for his consistently excellent performance and wish him much success in the future, both professionally and personally.

Leipzig, March 15, 2024



Sarah Kilz
Deputy group management



Aron Geißler
Head of administration